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No. 44

LIFE SITUATIONS

COLLECTION

First Home Purchase for Newcomers

Buying in Quebec when you come from elsewhere — key steps and local rules.



2026 EDITION

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It presents general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. Every real estate situation is different, and you should consult the appropriate professionals before making a decision about a transaction.

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First Home Purchase for Newcomers · Collection Life Situations · Guide No. 44 · 2026 Edition

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First Home Purchase for Newcomers

Buying in Quebec when you come from elsewhere — key steps and local rules

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Buying a first property in Quebec when you have just arrived involves particular challenges: building local credit, understanding a different system, and navigating vocabulary and rules specific to the province. Well accompanied, it is completely accessible.

This guide provides guidelines for newcomers: credit and financing, Quebec specificities, and steps to prepare.

Informative content. Each chapter ends with a lined “My Notes” page.

Buying a first property in Quebec as a newcomer involves particular challenges: building local credit, understanding a different system, learning your own vocabulary. Well accompanied, it is completely accessible. This guide gives the key points.

Informative content: validate your situation with the professionals concerned.

CHAPTER

Building your credit and financing file

> *Make yourself financeable in the local system.*

Lenders look at your **Canadian credit**, your income and your stability. A local credit history can take time to build.

- Start building credit early (card, on-time payments).
- Gather proof of income and employment.
- Explore the **programs for newcomers**, under special conditions.

The more solid and documented your file is, the simpler and more advantageous the financing will be.

Lenders look at your Canadian credit, your income and your stability. A local history takes time to build: open a card when you arrive and pay it in full each month. Some programs for newcomers offer adapted conditions, via a mortgage broker.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Open a credit card upon arrival and pay it in full each month. Building a Canadian history takes months: start well before you think about buying.*

CHAPTER

Understanding Quebec specificities

> *Learn the rules of the local game.*

The Quebec system has its particularities, often different from what exists elsewhere:

- Role of **notary** (mandatory) and **broker** (supervised by the OACIQ).
- **Welcome tax**, municipal and school taxes.
- Co-ownership **divides/undivides**, leases and rental rules if plex.
- Particularities of the building (clay soils, French drain, heating, winter).

Understanding them in advance avoids many costly surprises.

The Quebec system has its particularities: mandatory notary, broker supervised by the OACIQ, welcome tax, divided/undivided co-ownership, leases if plex, and a building specific to the climate (clay soils, French drain, winter). Learning the local vocabulary already means avoiding half of the mistakes.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Take the time to learn the local vocabulary: "welcome tax", "certificate of location", "conditions of the promise to purchase". Understanding words already means avoiding half of the mistakes.*

CHAPTER

Prepare yourself and surround yourself well

> *Move forward with confidence.*

As any first buyer, prepare the foundations:

- Establish a **budget** realistic.
- Obtain a **pre-approval** mortgage.
- Define your **criteria** and your sectors.

As a bonus, surround yourself with professionals who understand your journey (broker, mortgage broker, notary). Learning the local market before you buy is an investment that pays off.

As any first buyer, lay the foundations: realistic budget, pre-approval, criteria and sectors. As a bonus, surround yourself with professionals used to supporting newcomers - a good broker will explain not only the houses, but the entire system around them.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Choose professionals used to supporting newcomers. A good broker will explain not only the houses, but the whole system around them - it's invaluable.*

CHAPTER

Down payment and available assistance

> *Gather and optimize your contribution.*

The **down payment Minimum** depends on the price of the property; below a certain threshold, a **loan insurance** is added to the financing.

- Save early and automate your payments.
- Check your eligibility for **assistance programs** and incentives (depending on your status and situation).
- A **donation** family is accepted with a donation letter.

A mortgage broker can help you put everything together in the most advantageous way.

The minimum down payment depends on the price; below 20%, loan insurance is added. Save early, check your eligibility for assistance programs, and know that a family donation is accepted with a donation letter. A mortgage broker helps you put everything together advantageously.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Find out about programs for first-time buyers and newcomers: some offer favorable conditions. A mortgage broker knows what you are entitled to.*

CHAPTER

From research to taking possession

> *Follow the route step by step.*

Once financed and well supported, the purchasing process follows a clear logic:

1. **Visit** according to your criteria and sectors.
2. Make a **promise to purchase** with the right conditions (financing, inspection).
3. Carry out the**inspection** and lift the conditions.
4. Sign with the **notary** and take possession.

At each stage, ask your questions: no one expects a newcomer to already know the entire system.

The route follows a clear logic: visit according to your criteria, make a promise to purchase with the right conditions (financing, inspection), lift the conditions after inspection, then sign with the notary. At each stage, ask your questions: no one expects a newcomer to already know everything.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Don't be afraid to ask “too many” questions. A good professional would rather answer your questions a thousand times than see you sign without understanding. This is your biggest purchase.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. Start or consolidate my Canadian credit.
2. Gather my proof of income and employment.

Within 30 days

1. Meet a mortgage broker (newcomer programs).
2. Inform me about Quebec specificities.

Then

1. Obtain pre-approval and launch my search with Emilie.

To prepare myself

1. Build my Canadian credit and gather my proof of income.
2. Meet with a mortgage broker (newcomer programs) and obtain pre-approval.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Canadian credit: local history, key to financing.
- Newcomer programs: adapted loan conditions, via a broker.
- OACIQ: organization governing real estate brokers.
- Welcome tax: municipal transfer taxes.
- Pre-approval: amount and rate confirmed before shopping.

- Canadian credit: local history, key to financing.
- Newcomer programs: adapted loan conditions, via a broker.
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GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. Lenders mainly look at:

A) Your credit from another country
B) Your Canadian credit, income and stability
C) Your age
D) Your hobbies

2. To build local credit, you must:

A) Wait ten years
B) Start early (card, on-time payments)
C) Avoid all credit
D) Pay cash

3. In Quebec, the notary is:

A) Optional
B) Mandatory for sale
C) Prohibited
D) The seller

4. The welcome tax is:

A) A gift
B) Municipal transfer duties
C) Insurance
D) Rent

5. Before shopping, it is wise to have:

A) No preparation
B) A budget and pre-approval
C) A single visit
D) A mover

6. Surrounding yourself well means choosing professionals who:

A) Ignoring your background
B) Understand the journey of newcomers
C) Speak quickly
D) Do not respond

7. Below a certain down payment threshold:

A) Purchase is prohibited
B) Loan insurance is added to the financing
C) Taxes disappear
D) The notary is free

8. A family donation for the down payment:

A) Is refused
B) Is accepted with a donation letter
C) Double the taxes
D) Is illegal

9. A prudent purchase promise includes:

A) No conditions
B) Conditions (financing, inspection)
C) A secret price
D) Nothing

10. For a newcomer, asking questions is:

A) Embarrassing
B) Normal and encouraged
C) Prohibited
D) Useless

Answers

1. B - Canadian credit (chap. 1).
2. B - Start early (chap. 1).
3. B - Mandatory notary (chap. 2).
4. B - Transfer duties (chap. 2).
5. B - Budget + pre-approval (chap. 3).
6. B - Adapted support (chap. 3).
7. B - Loan insurance (chap. 4).
8. B - Donation letter (chap. 4).
9. B - Protective conditions (chap. 5).
10. B - No one expects him to know everything (chap. 5).

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You now have the right keys in hand.

Every real estate journey is different.

If you would like to go further,
I would be happy to discuss
your project with you.



Make informed decisions.
Choose with confidence.
Live without regrets.
See you soon,
Emilie ☺

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